

Unit Y304: The Church and Medieval Heresy c.1100–1437

This theme focuses on the nature and extent of heresy in Medieval Europe and the response of the Catholic Church during this period. Although questions will not be set in isolation on specific heretical movements, the following movements should be studied: Cathars, Waldensians, Hussites, Lollards, Bogomils, Free Spirit, Fraticelli, Henricians, Patarenes. The strands identified below are not to be studied in isolation to each other.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: The Church and Medieval Heresy c.1100–1437	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
The causes and nature of the heretical movements	The condition of the medieval Church, the geo-political structure of medieval Europe, increase in lay piety, intellectual developments, the geographical spread of heresy, the size of the movements, frequency and duration; the strategy and organisation of the movements.
Support for heretical movements	Nature of the support: gender, social class and age; the leadership and organisation of the heretical movements; the differences between the movements; the reasons for the limited success and/or failure of the movements.
The impact of heretical movements upon the medieval Church	The response of the medieval church to the threat of heresy at the time, the Crusades against heresy, the extent to which heresy presented a challenge to the medieval Church.
Maintenance of church authority	Propaganda produced against heresy, individual clerical responses (Bernard of Clairvaux/Caesarius of Heisterbach); preaching tours (Bernard of Clairvaux Languedoc 1140s), Church councils (4th Lateran Council 1215); statutes; punishments; popular support for the Catholic Church; counter-movements; literature produced against heresy (Sermons on the Song of Songs); creation of spiritual orders (Franciscans, Dominicans); the Medieval Inquisition (Bernard Gui, Jacques Fournier).

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Depth studies	Content Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
John Wycliffe and the Lollards to c.1420	Wycliffe's views and writings; Wycliffe's attacks on the Papacy and monasticism, his doctrine of the church, his views on the Bible; the appeal of his writing; political support for Wycliffe and the reasons for this support; responses to Wycliffe's writings and preaching; Lollardy, the beliefs of Lollards, reasons for and the extent of support, nature, geography and social composition of the support, duration of the movement; response by the authorities to Wycliffe and Lollards, reasons for the failure of Lollardy.
The Mendicant Orders	St Dominic and his approach to the Cathars; the founding of the Dominicans as a preaching order; the Dominicans and the universities; St Francis, poverty and the founding of the Franciscans and Poor Clares, the split between Spirituals (Joachim of Fiore) and Conventionals; the impact of the Mendicant Orders on the towns.
Huss and the Hussites 1400–1436	The influence of Wycliffe and Huss' attack on the Church; Bohemian nationalism; the Council of Constance 1414–1415; creation and beliefs of a Bohemian Church 1415–1419; Papal and imperial attitudes; the Hussite settlements; the Hussite Wars and Crusades 1419–1434; divisions between moderates and radicals (Taborites), the leadership of Zizka and final defeat 1434; foreign involvement (German rulers, Poland and Lithuania); Council of Basle 1431–1436 and the Compacts of 1436; Bohemian Church survival and the Moravian Brethren; the extent of Bohemian and Hussite social, political and cultural revolution.